



BOOKER ACADEMY

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27th September, 2019

Dear Admissions Committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION LETTER FOR JOAN NEKOYE

Joan Nekoye was not an exception to the classic phase that every new music student goes through: The yearning to play every musical instrument they can get their hands on. As common as it is, it was different in her case because she never lost the zeal after a few days or weeks and from this, I saw a true reflection of her consistency and her potential.

The instrument she took to was the violin. Anyone who plays the violin knows that it can be frustrating because one requires perfect pitch and quick fingers to maneuver it. One evening I heard her in the practice room trying to nail the vibrato in a Fur Elise piece without success. She kept coming back each day, seeking assistance from senior students and myself and then trying over and over again without giving up. A few weeks later, she was doing a duet of the same piece with one of the fourth-year students in front of the whole school! Fast-forward 3 years later, it is the same drive, effort, and dedication that enabled her to emerge second place nationally in the Violin solo during the 2018 Kenya National Music Festival.

Her leadership abilities spoke for themselves as well. As chairperson of the Booker Academy Music Society, she assumed the task with ease and devotion. Her strength undoubtedly lay in her creativity. For example, at one point there was a shortage of funding for the acquisition of new musical instruments. She suggested getting the county government to allow the school brass band to play during public functions and national holiday celebrations. Sure enough, the proposal was accepted and the school band was officially appointed as the music provider during such events since then. This has enabled the purchase of new musical instruments to keep the music alive within the school.

Throughout my time as an educator, I can truly say that I am yet to meet a student who plays the role of a team leader and a team player as well as she does. High school is a journey of growth for each individual who goes through it and for the students who came after her year, especially the music students she managed to personally interact with, Joan was the person who guided them through. She listened more than she instructed during choir practice and during her senior year, she would often drop her spot in some string quartet performance or some vocal duet to allow those in lower classes who had budding talents, to grow as well. I believe her selfless nature and spreading of knowledge greatly contributed to the school emerging the best overall high school during the 2018 Kenya National Music Festival. This was a record high for the school and the fact

that it happened under her regime as Chairlady as well as during her final school year, where she had to balance her music with her final exams, is an achievement that she will always be remembered and appreciated for.

Joan was one of those students a teacher never forgets and whose name continues to live through current students' narrations of her. Regardless, of whatever path she chooses in life, she is sure to leave her mark. I therefore strongly recommend her to your institution.

Yours sincerely,



Mr. Bevan Mayaka

HEAD OF THE DEPARTMENT OF MUSIC